

Hope is an [optimistic state of mind](#) that is based on an [expectation](#) of positive outcomes with respect to events and circumstances in one's own life, or the world at large.^[1] As a verb, Merriam-Webster defines *hope* as "to expect with confidence" or "to cherish a [desire](#) with anticipation".^[2]

Among its opposites are dejection, [hopelessness](#), and [despair](#).^[3]